

### 6.1.3 Carboxylic acids and esters

| Learning outcomes                                                                                                              | Additional guidance                                                                                       |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <i>Learners should be able to demonstrate and apply their knowledge and understanding of:</i>                                  |                                                                                                           |
| <b>Properties of carboxylic acids</b>                                                                                          |                                                                                                           |
| (a) explanation of the water solubility of carboxylic acids in terms of hydrogen bonding                                       |                                                                                                           |
| (b) reactions in aqueous conditions of carboxylic acids with metals and bases (including carbonates, metal oxides and alkalis) | Comparison of acidity of different carboxylic acids <b>not</b> required.<br><br><b>PAG7 (see 6.3.1 c)</b> |

## Esters

- (c) esterification of:
  - (i) carboxylic acids with alcohols in the presence of an acid catalyst (e.g. concentrated  $\text{H}_2\text{SO}_4$ )
  - (ii) acid anhydrides with alcohols
- (d) hydrolysis of esters:
  - (i) in hot aqueous acid to form carboxylic acids and alcohols
  - (ii) in hot aqueous alkali to form carboxylate salts and alcohols

## Acyl chlorides

- (e) the formation of acyl chlorides from carboxylic acids using  $\text{SOCl}_2$
  - (f) use of acyl chlorides in synthesis in formation of esters, carboxylic acids and primary and secondary amides.
- Including esterification of phenol, which is not readily esterified by carboxylic acids.